

Instructor Guide — Course 17, Lesson 8: The Client Simulation

Lesson Metadata

Field	Value
Course	17 — Skills That Pay
Lesson	8 of 8 (final) — The Client Simulation
Age	15–18
Duration	2–3 class sessions (recommended: 3 × 60–75 min)
Difficulty	Intermediate — capstone lesson
Prerequisites	Lessons 1–7 complete (service package, pricing, proposal skills, communication norms)
Tools	Google Docs, Canva, Notion, Email, Spreadsheets
Objectives	Execute a complete, realistic client engagement from inquiry to handoff, entirely in simulation
Deliverables	Full simulated client project package (see checklist below)
Skills	Discovery, scoping, proposing, delivering, handling feedback, professional communication under realistic constraints
Portfolio connection	The finished simulated project becomes a strong new case study candidate for the student's Course 16 portfolio

Lesson Overview

This is the capstone of Course 17. Students step through an entire fictional client engagement — introduction, discovery, proposal, execution, feedback, revision, and handoff — using **Career Compass Club**, a fictional student-run school club, as the client. Every document needed is provided in [Simulation_Resources/](#). Nothing here requires or implies a real client, real payment, or a real legally binding contract — this is stated explicitly to students at the start (see Student_Lesson.md) and on every simulation document.

Instructor Prep

- Read through all of [Simulation_Resources/](#) once before teaching — the fictional client (Priya Alvarez, faculty advisor of Career Compass Club) has a consistent voice across the inquiry email, discovery script, feedback, and revision request. You will be role-playing this client during the discovery call and feedback stages.
- Decide whether students work individually or in pairs.
- Print or share [Simulation_Resources/Sample_Completed_Solution.md](#) only AFTER grading, as a reference — not before, so it doesn't short-circuit students' own proposal-writing.

Required Files

All in [Simulation_Resources/](#) : Fictional_Client_Profile.md, Client_Inquiry_Email.md, Discovery_Call_Script.md, Project_Requirements.md, Proposal_Template.md (reused from L7), Pricing_Scope_Worksheet.md, Client_Feedback.md, Revision_Request.md, Final_Handoff_Checklist.md, Sample_Completed_Solution.md, Evaluation_Rubric.md, Reflection_Worksheet.md.

Teaching Sequence (across 3 sessions)

Session	Time	Activity
1	0–15 min	Set the frame: this is a full simulation, fully fictional, safe to fail and iterate
1	15–30 min	Distribute Client_Inquiry_Email.md ; students read and note initial questions
1	30–60 min	Run the Discovery Call as a role-play — instructor plays Priya using Discovery_Call_Script.md ; students ask questions and take notes
1	60–75 min	Students begin Project_Requirements.md (scope notes) individually
2	0–30 min	Students draft their Proposal (using the Lesson 7 Proposal_Template.md) and Pricing_Scope_Worksheet.md
2	30–45 min	Peer review: swap proposals, give one piece of feedback each
2	45–75 min	Students revise and finalize their proposal; "submit" to instructor
3	0–10 min	Instructor distributes Client_Feedback.md (approval + one requested change) to every student, playing the client's response
3	10–40 min	Students execute the one requested change (a scope-appropriate revision, e.g. adjusting a page's content, not a full rebuild) and document it
3	40–55 min	Students complete Final_Handoff_Checklist.md and write a short handoff message

Session	Time	Activity
3	55–75 min	Reflection (Reflection_Worksheet.md) and instructor debrief using Evaluation_Rubric.md

Instructor Talking Points

- "Every real client engagement has these same beats: someone reaches out, you ask questions, you propose a plan, you deliver, they give feedback, you adjust, you hand off. Today you do all six, safely, in one class arc."
- Reinforce throughout: this is fictional, for practice — no real payment changes hands, and nothing here is a real legal contract.

Common Misconceptions

- "The client's first message tells me everything I need." → Discovery questions matter; a vague inquiry always needs clarifying questions before a real proposal can be written.
- "Feedback means I did something wrong." → Model that even a strong first delivery normally gets at least one adjustment request — that's normal, not a failure.

Likely Student Difficulties & Troubleshooting

Issue	Fix
Student proposal ignores discovery-call details	Have them re-read Discovery_Call_Script.md notes before revising
Scope creep during the "revision" stage	Point back to Pricing_Scope_Worksheet.md — is this change inside or outside original scope?
Student unsure how to respond to feedback professionally	Model a sample reply on the board using L7's communication norms

How to Review Student Work

Grade using [Evaluation_Rubric.md](#) . Look for: discovery notes that reflect the call, a proposal matching the requirements, a revision that's professionally communicated, and a completed handoff checklist.

Lesson Close

"You just completed a full client engagement without any of the risk of a real one. This project can become a new case study in your Course 16 portfolio. Next up: Course 18, where we make sure people can actually find you."